

Dichotomy: there are exactly two states in the afterlife, heaven and hell.

Non-universality: some
people go to heaven,
and some to hell.

Divine control: it is up
to God who goes to heaven
and who goes to hell.

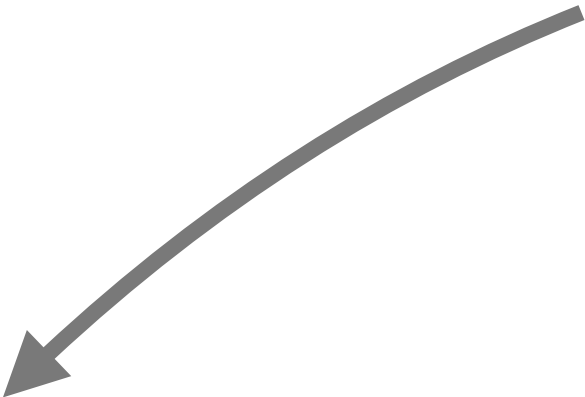
Proportionality: justice is proportional, in the sense that it “prohibits very unequal treatment of persons who are very similar in relevant respects.”

By Non-universality and Divine control, it follows that God decides that some people - call them group A - go to heaven and that some other people - group B - go to hell. By Badness, it follows that group A is much better off than group B. By Dichotomy, it follows that every human being is either in group A or group B. By Proportionality (given that the people in group A are much, much better off than the ones in group B), it follows that if God is just, there must be some way of dividing people into groups A and B which does not place people who are relevantly very similar into different groups. So by Justice, it follows that there must be some way of dividing people into groups A and B which does not place people who are relevantly very similar into different groups.

Justice: God's judgement about who goes to heaven & hell is just.

God sends some people
(group A) to heaven
and everyone else
(group B) to hell.





Let's try to lay out Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the **traditional doctrine** of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with the existence of a perfectly good God.

“A certain traditional conception of the afterlife is *binary*. After death one proceeds either to heaven or hell. Heaven is very, very good; hell is very, very bad. There are no possibilities for the afterlife other than heaven and hell, and membership in heaven or hell is never indeterminate or a matter of degree. The problem with the binary conception is that it contradicts God's justice. God must employ some criterion to decide who goes to heaven and who goes to hell. No reasonable criterion would be sharp; any reasonable criterion will have borderline cases. But the binary conception of the afterlife allows for no corresponding fuzziness in how the dead are to be treated. Hell must therefore contain people who are nearly indiscernible in relevant respects from people in Heaven. No just God would allow such a monstrously unfair thing.”

It is part of the traditional doctrine that God decides whether people go to heaven and hell based on certain properties of those people. We will leave open for now what those properties might be; just to have a name for them, let's call them the **relevant properties**.

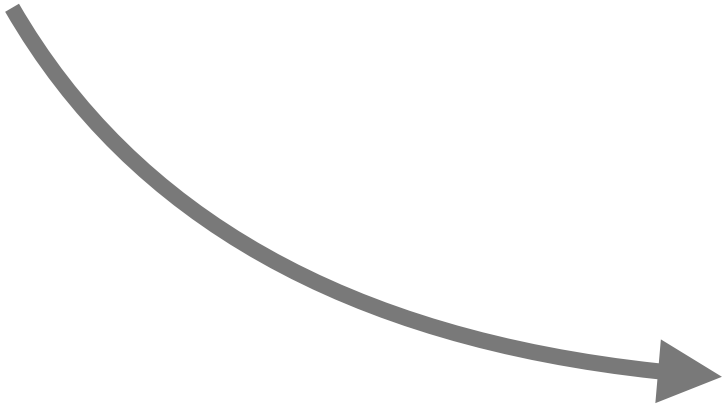
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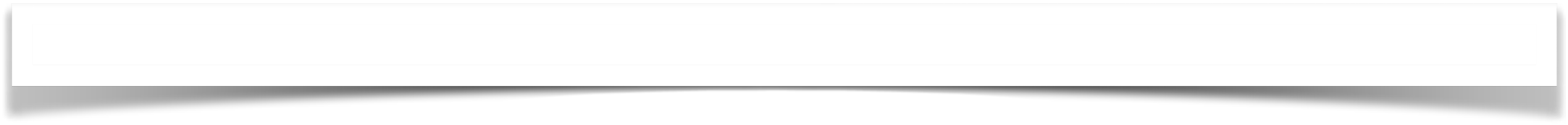
the
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replies to the
paradox



evil & lives
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Non-invertibility: some

and some here.

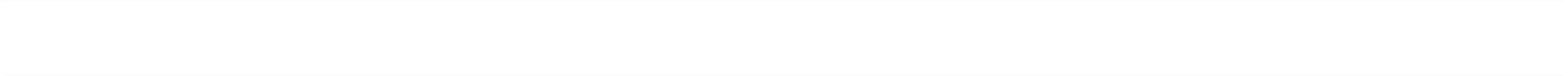
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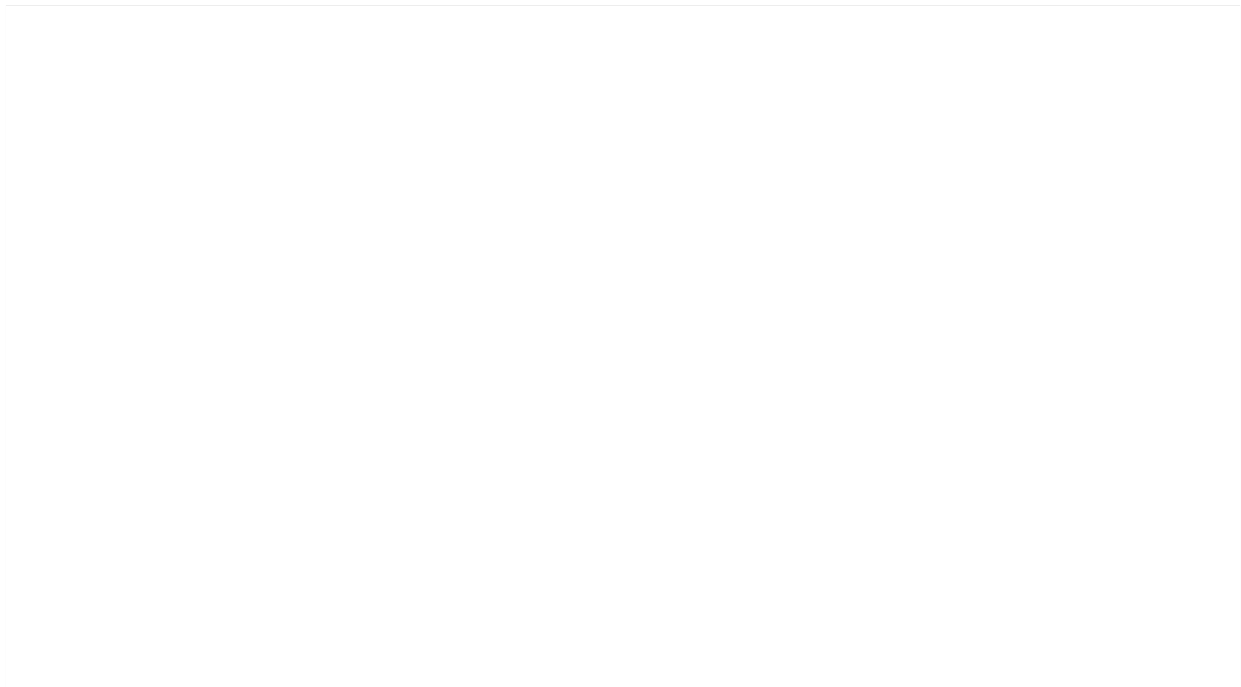
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mirrored better off

The following passage from the Catechism of the Catholic Church

describes the kind of view wanted to discuss:



another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

1038. The resurrection of all the dead, 'of both the

all the nations, and he will separate them one from

the angels with him... Before him will be gathered

Judgment. Christ will come "in his glory, and all

just and the unjust,' will precede the Last

but the goats at the left.... and they will go away

into external punishment, but the rights into

goats, and he will place the sheep at his right hand,

eternis in die !!

One topic often associated with belief in God is the topic of life after death.

many of the major monotheistic religions compatible with the existence of a

Our first question today is: what we are told about life after death by

perfectly good Good?



goats, and the wild prairie sheep at his

the Last Judgment. . . Christ will come "in

right hand, but the goat at the left... and

this glory, and all the angels with him.

they will go away into eternal punishment,

and the wild sheep are then driven

both the just and the unjust," will proceed

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This certainly seems like a picture according to which, after death, God passes

judgement on all of us, and on the basis of our life, decides that some of us will

got to heaven forever, and some to hell forever. (If not 'forever', then the

talk of the last judgment wouldn't make much sense.)

Turned-in showed why it is plausible that respo to the argument from evil

must depend on the possibility of life after death. We will now ask: is the kind of

view of life after death we get here on pain of being perfectly good?



the
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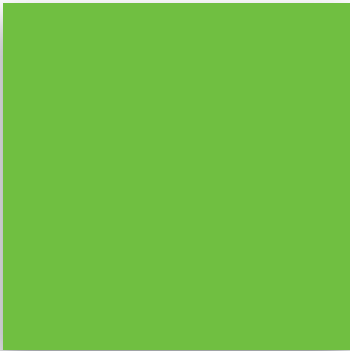
replies to the
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A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "evil & lives not worth living" is written in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font, arranged in three lines.

evil & lives
not worth
living



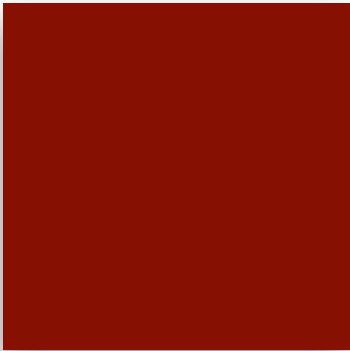














It seems difficult to deny Justice, Badness, or Divine Control. So that

seems to give the defender of the afterlife further main options.



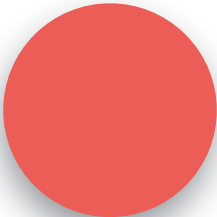




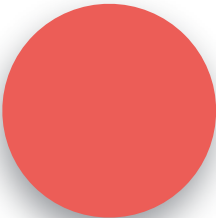




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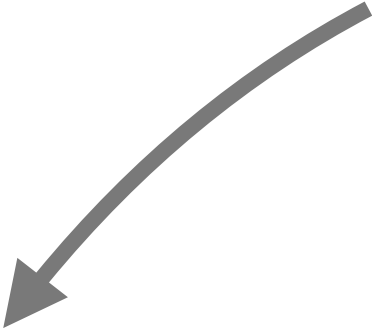
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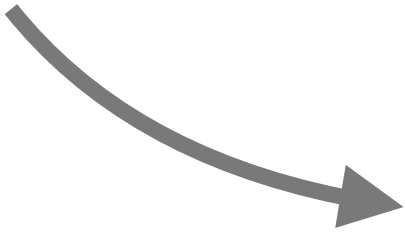
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